Tennessee Comprehensive Assessment Program

TCAP

Science
Grade 3
Practice Items

TN Department of Education

Which statement **best** explains the water that is found on Earth.

A. It is only a liquid and stays where it is found.

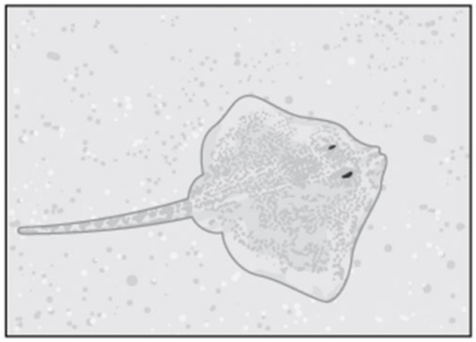
B. It is only a liquid and moves around the Earth.

C. It can be a solid, liquid, or gas and stays where it is found.

D. It can be a solid, liquid, or gas and moves around the Earth.

Stingrays have special skin colors and patterns. Students are asked to make a claim about the reason why these special skin colors and patterns help the stingray survive.

Stingray



A student says that these special skin colors and patterns help the stingrays avoid predators. Which evidence **best** supports the student's claim?

A. the size of the stingray

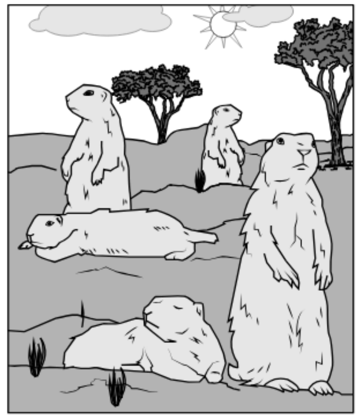
B. the appetite of the stingray

C. the ability to stay on the ocean floor

D. the ability to blend in with the ocean floor

The picture shows some prairie dogs.

Group of Prairie Dogs



A student claims that living in groups helps prairie dogs.
Which **two** observations of these prairie dogs would support the student's claim?

M. They are active at night.

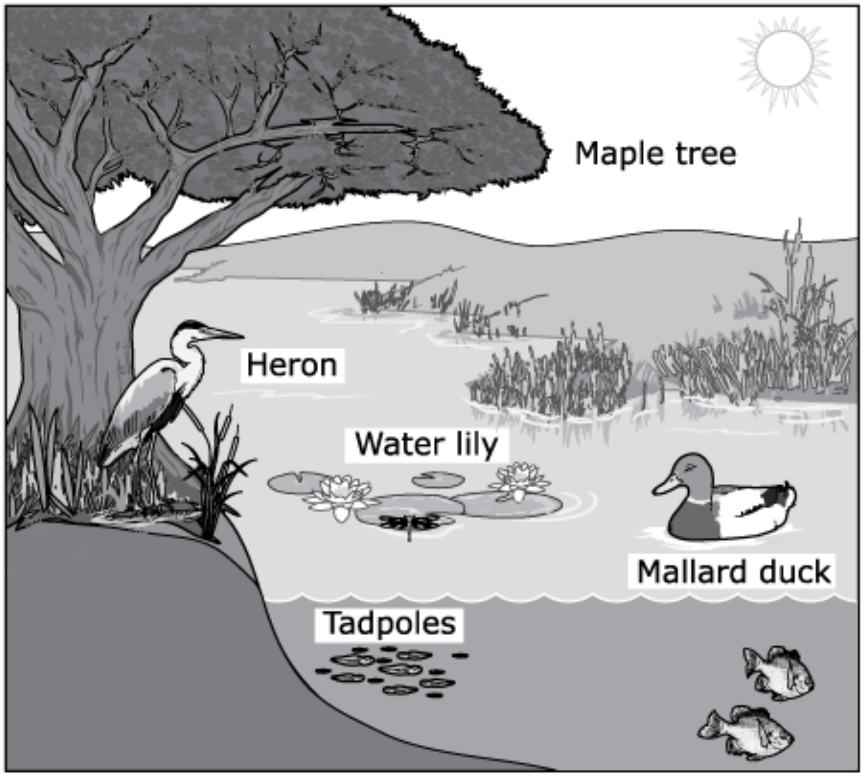
P. They raise their young together.

R. They are easily seen by predators.

S. They take turns watching for predators.

T. They are less selective about what they eat.

A pond is shown. During the hot summer months, the water in the pond gets lower. By the end of the summer, the pond has completely dried up.



Which **three** results are **most likely** due to the loss of the pond?

A. The roots of the maple tree will grow deeper in the soil to find water.

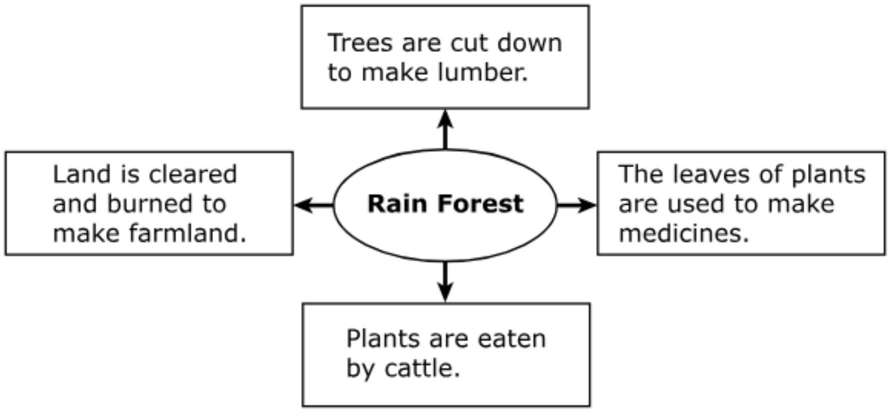
B. The heron will move to another pond with water.

C. The water lily will wilt and die in the dry pond.

D. The fish will move to another pond with water.

E. The mallard duck will build a nest in the dry pond.

Students look at a diagram of rain forest resources. The diagram shows how rain forest resources are used.



Based on the diagram, if the rain forest is cleared, which natural resource will be **most likely** lost?

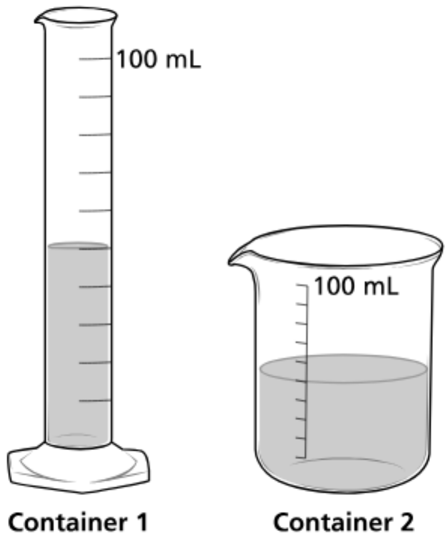
A. types of cattle

B. lumber used for building

C. land used for farming

D. plants used for medicine

A student puts 50 milliliters of water into two different containers, as shown.



Which of these **best** compares the properties of the water in each container?

M. The volume and shape of the water both stay the same.

P. The volume of the water changes, but the shape stays the same.

R. The shape of the water changes, but the volume stays the same.

S. The volume and shape of the water both change.

A teacher showed four objects to a class. The teacher heated each object until it changed. The data table lists the objects and describes how each object changed.

Student Results

Before Heating	After Heating
Solid butter	Liquid butter
Solid chocolate	Melted chocolate
Raw egg	Cooked egg
Candle wax	Melted wax

Which object's change may **not** be reversed by cooling?

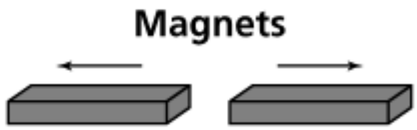
A. butter

B. chocolate

C. egg

D. wax

A student places two magnets end to end. The magnets push away from each other.



These magnets push away from each other because

A. each magnet has a different mass.

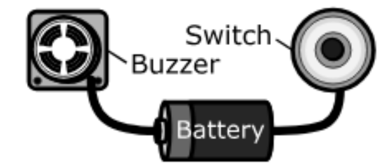
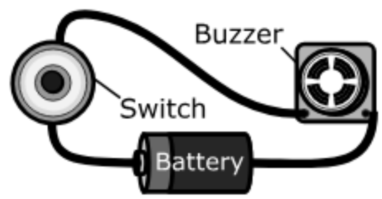
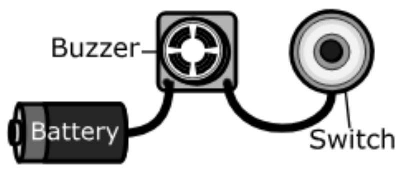
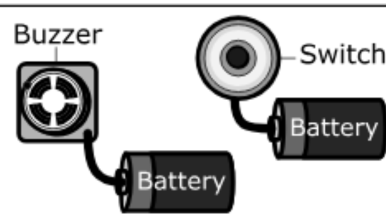
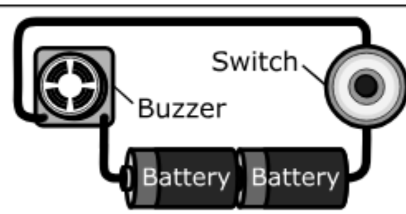
B. each magnet is made of a different material.

C. the south pole of one magnet is lined up with the south pole of the other magnet.

D. the south pole of one magnet is lined up with the north pole of the other magnet.

The table shows some examples of working and nonworking circuits.

Working and Nonworking Circuits

Status	Circuit Design
Nonworking	
Working	
Nonworking	
Nonworking	
Working	

Which statement is **correct** about the working and nonworking circuits in the table?

A. Working circuits contain closed loops.

B. Nonworking circuits connect the buzzer and switch.

C. Nonworking circuits use only one battery.

D. Working circuits need at least four wires.

Students tested the strength of five magnets. The students put a paper clip on a desk. They slowly pushed each magnet toward the paper clip from far away. They stopped pushing the magnet as soon as the paper clip started to slide toward the magnet. Then they measured the distance between the magnet and the paper clip. They recorded the distance in the data table shown.

Magnet Strength Data

Magnet	Distance (inches)
V	1
W	2
X	2
Y	4
Z	5

Which **two** statements correctly describe these data?

M. Magnet V has the weakest pull.

P. Magnet V is stronger than Magnet Z.

R. Magnet W is as strong as Magnet X.

S. Magnet Y has the strongest pull.

T. All of the magnets are the same strength.

The table lists objects found in space.

Objects in Space

Object	Location	Description
1	Orbiting the sun between Mars and Jupiter	Large rocky body with many craters
2	Orbiting the sun beyond Neptune	Small ball of ice, rock, and dust with two tails
3	Orbiting Saturn	Large rocky body with an atmosphere
4	Orbiting Earth	Large rocky body with many craters

Which objects are most likely moons?

A. Objects 1 and 2.

B. Objects 2 and 4.

C. Objects 3 and 4.

D. Objects 1 and 3.

Metadata- Science Items

Page Number	Item Type	Key	TN Standards
1	MC	D	3.ESS2.2
2	MC	D	3.LS1.2
3	MS	P,S	3.LS2.1
4	MS	A,B,C	3.LS4.1
5	MC	D	3.LS4.2
6	MC	R	3.PS1.3
7	MC	C	3.PS1.2
8	MC	C	3.PS2.1
9	MC	A	3.PS3.2
10	MS	M,R	3.PS3.3
11	MC	C	3.ESS1.1
Metadata Definitions			
Item Type	MC = Multiple Choice MS = Multiple Select		
Key	Correct answer		
TN Standards	Primary educational standard assessed.		